



Kawe Mahara
Queer Archives Aotearoa

KAMP

Knowledge And Memory Pack for
Queer History Month Aotearoa
Pūmahara Ia Te Wā **July 2026**





**The kaupapa of this pack is to celebrate, educate,
and inspire individuals and organisations
to celebrate Queer History Month Aotearoa
Pūmahara Ia Te Wā in July 2026.**

This pack includes a range of terms and acronyms such as LGBT, LGBTI, LGBTQIA+, and others. These reflect the language used by the organisations, resources, and references included throughout the pack and have been retained as originally presented.

Regardless of the terminology used, this pack is intended to be inclusive of all rainbow communities.

All materials in this pack, except photographs, are free to use for community education and events, but please credit Kawe Mahara Queer Archives Aotearoa.

Please do not reproduce any photographs in this Pack without contacting the curators at Kawe Mahara first: curators@laganz.org.nz

Creation of the pack was led by Dr Lori Leigh with material supplied by current and former Trustees of Kawe Mahara. Design by Alex Hawkhead.

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Setting up KAMP

Introduction

Kawe Mahara Queer Archives Aotearoa is a rich pātaka of queer and takatāpui taonga and stories.

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He kitenga kanohi, he hokinga mahara
He kawenga mahara, he hapori kitea

A familiar face stirs one's memories
A collection of memories is a community seen

'Queer' is an umbrella term for people who identify with diverse sexual orientations, gender identities, gender expressions and innate variations of sex characteristics, in acknowledgement of the fluidity of identities and the multiple acts of identifying and finding ourselves through time and space.

Kawe Mahara Queer Archives Aotearoa (formerly known as the Lesbian and Gay Archives of New Zealand Te Pūranga Takatāpui o Aotearoa) welcomes the many intersections with other identities, communities and politics that 'queer' holds.

Kamp/camp is also a term used by LGBTTIQ people in Aotearoa pre-1970s to describe themselves and others.

Kawe means 'to carry, convey, bear' and mahara means 'memory, recollection, knowledge'. Kawe Mahara stands for carrying the memories of all our takatāpui and queer communities in Aotearoa from the past, present and future, so that our communities can grow and thrive. Having survived an arson attack in the 1980s, and kept alive by volunteers through decades of discrimination, Kawe Mahara is a testament to the power of community archives.

Aotearoa's first Queer History Month, with te reo Māori name Pūmahara Ia Te Wā, was launched in July 2024, breathed into being by Kawe Mahara Queer Archives Aotearoa. In the inaugural Queer History Month Aotearoa, Kawe Mahara alongside the National Library hosted an all-day hui in Te Whanganui-a-Tara. The hui taumata on 9 July 2024 marked the passing of the Homosexual Law Reform Act in Aotearoa on 9 July 1986, and stressed the importance of preserving and sharing Aotearoa's iconic yet undershared queer histories. Detailed information about that first event and the speakers can be found here: <https://natlib.govt.nz/events/queer-history-month-aotearoa-pumahara-ia-te-wa-2024-hui-taumata-july-09-2024>

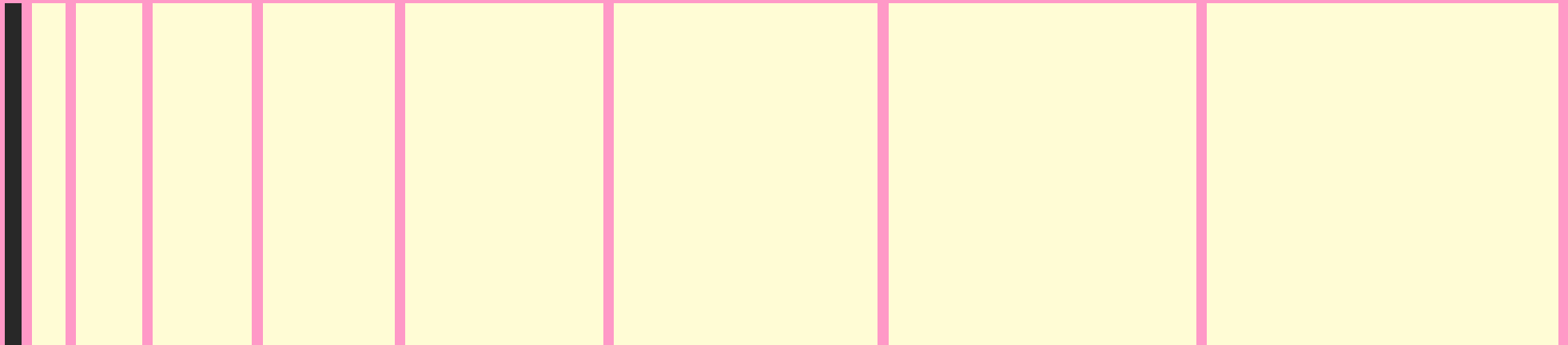
This year, 2026, marks the 40th anniversary of the Homosexual Law Reform Act in Aotearoa. Kawe Mahara has created this Knowledge And Resource Pack (KAMP) to encourage community groups, libraries, archives and schools across the motu to celebrate and honour Aotearoa's diverse and rich queer history.

There are many ways to show your manaaki for your local queer communities, and it is our hope that this pack can provide a roadmap through resources, information and activities. Planning a display, using the Queer History Month Aotearoa logo and email signature in online activities, or hosting a queer history quiz are just some ideas. The kaupapa of this pack, however, is that you use it to inspire your own ideas and māhi. Our aim is to continue to build upon this pack in years to come so it is in no way definitive or inclusive of the entire queer history landscape of Aotearoa.

It is just a step in a long journey towards keeping queer history alive.

- Dr Lori Leigh

What is Queer History Month?



What is Queer History Month?

Our mission is to share knowledge; to support existing LGBTQ+ History Month projects; and to encourage new LGBTQ+ History Months around the world.

Inspired by the United States of America's Black History Month, founded in 1926 by Black historian, Carter G. Woodrow. When other communities followed, Women's History Month, Latino History Month, Rodney thought why not 'Gay History Month!'.

The first LGBT History Month was founded thirty years ago in the United States by Rodney Wilson. Rodney went on to lead the way of honouring and remembering the LGBTQI+ people and places of significance from Stonewall and gay liberation to the community activists and leaders throughout the queer community. Over the years, Rodney has continued to lead the conversations with every new member country and share the highs and lows of queer history as politics and ideologies change across the decades.

On January 14th, 2022 the International Committee of LGBT History Months had its first online meeting. Each country gains support and ideas to facilitate their own queer history month.

They have included queer history heritage walks, PRIDE parades, oral histories, podcasts, filmmakers, writers and artists and symposiums.

Since its beginning, the International Network has met every quarter and as it grows is also diversifying in its intercultural connections representing 22 countries and 38 members. The international movement has grown and now share resources and support as our global queer communities are facing new challenges and threats.

There is a Code of Ethics of Queer History Months outlined to honour all LGBTQI+ communities.

Queer History Month Aotearoa Pūmahara Ia Te Wa

Aotearoa, New Zealand was the 20th country to form a Queer History Month with a symposium in Wellington with support of the Trustees of Kawe Mahara Queer Archives Aotearoa in partnership with Te Puna Mātauranga o Aotearoa, the National Library of New Zealand.

International Committee on LGBTQ+ History Months Code of ethics

The International Committee on LGBTQ+ History Months is a worldwide initiative that aims to offer an inclusive, safe, and welcoming space to everyone.

- We believe in liberty and equality for all members of our community. We support and affirm everyone who identifies as LGBTQIA+ and/or queer.
- We oppose all forms of discrimination based on race, ethnicity, national origin, sex, economic status, disability, sexual orientation, and gender identity.
- We oppose violence, bullying, and harassment.
- We devote ourselves to "leading with love"; to inclusion; to peace; to placing a chair at our table for everyone; and to developing committee policies that facilitate these goals.
- We ask, therefore, that those joining our International Committee on LGBTQ+ History Months support these standards across all platforms both professional and personal, aim for these goals, and agree to this Code of Ethics.

The mission of the International Committee on LGBTQ+ History Months is to share knowledge; to support existing LGBTQ+ History Month projects; and to encourage new LGBTQ+ History Months around the world.

What is Queer History Month?

“LGBT history gave me self-confidence as a gay person and strengthened my resolve to live, as best I could, an honest, open and integrated life.”

– Rodney C Wilson, Founder and Chair of International LGBT+ History Month



Rodney Wilson (1994) by Msheble
Own Work, Licensed under CC BY-SA 4.0.
<https://commons.wikimedia.org/w/index.php?curid=178891438>

What is Queer History Month?

Meet New Zealand's representatives on the International Committee of LGBTQI+ History Months

Clare O'Leary (she/her)

Founding member and NZ rep on the ICoHMs. Past Trustee, Kawe Mahara Queer Archives Aotearoa.

Clare was the instigator of the first *Queer History Month Pūmahara Ia Te Wā*. She trained as a nurse and soon shifted to working in youth and community health education across sexuality, HIV/AIDS, and grief and loss.

As a documentary filmmaker, she has always woven lived experience and diversity into the research and campaigns she has led. She was active in the first national digital strategies across the cultural and creative sector and founding Content Director at NZONSCREEN.

She lives in Wellington with her partner and they have one son and three grandchildren.

Kevin Haunui

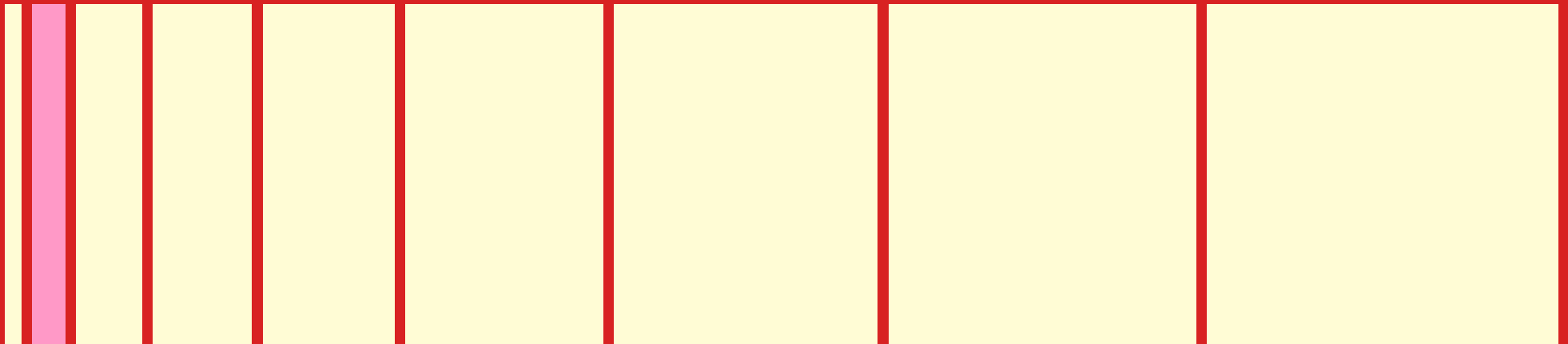
Chair of LAGANZ during its transition to Kawe Mahara Queer Archives Aotearoa.

Kevin joined the International Committee after the Pūmahara Ia Te Wā symposium in Wellington.

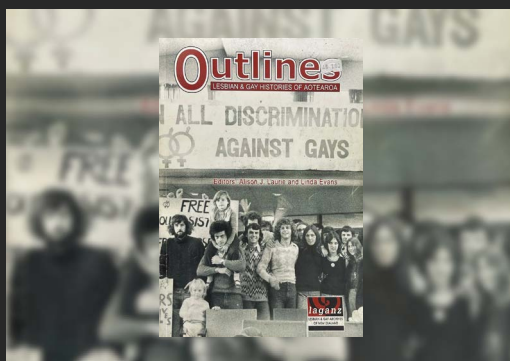


Reuben Love, Elizabeth Kerekere, Mani Mitchell, Donal Raethal, Clare O'Leary and Kevin Hanui

Rainbow reads & reels



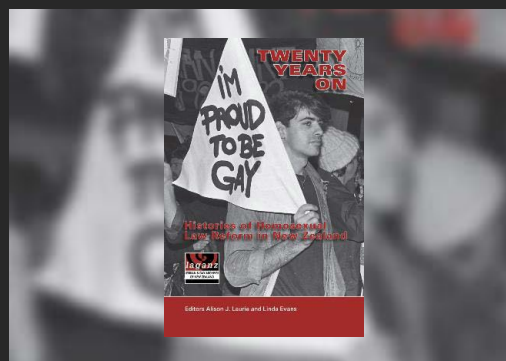
Kawe Mahara's reads



Outlines: Lesbian & Gay Histories of Aotearoa

Laurie, Alison J. and Linda Evans (eds.). *Outlines: Lesbian & Gay Histories of Aotearoa*. Lesbian & Gay Archives of New Zealand. 2005.

Outlines was one of Aotearoa's first queer history books! With entries from a range of authors, *Outlines* explores histories of pre-colonial takatāpui, gay liberation, homosexual law reform and more.



Twenty Years On: Histories of Homosexual Law Reform in New Zealand

Laurie, Alison J. and Linda Evans (eds.). *Twenty Years On: Histories of Homosexual Law Reform in New Zealand*. Lesbian & Gay Archives of New Zealand. 2009.

Twenty Years On is a collection of essays exploring different aspects of the homosexual law reform movement, including writings from activists involved in different campaign groups, a photo essay, and a chronology.



The Archive is Alive

The Archive is Alive zine series was created by Kawe Mahara in collaboration with Wellington Zinefest between 2020 and 2022.

The three volumes were created by participants over intensive two-day workshops, which involved a day of history and archives and a day of crafting. The second volume focuses specifically on trans histories, and the third on queer youth.

Non-fiction



Mates & Lovers: A History of Gay New Zealand

Brickell, Chris. *Mates & Lovers: A History of Gay New Zealand*. Random House. 2008. ISBN 9781869621346.

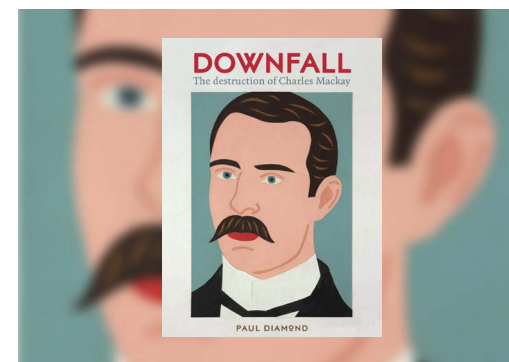
Mates & Lovers by Chris Brickell is a ground-breaking history of gay men in Aotearoa and the making of a modern “gay” identity, spanning from early colonisation to the 1980s. A treasure trove of stories, *Mates & Lovers* is a great read for high schoolers and retirees alike.



Sexuality & the Stories of Indigenous People

Hutchings, Jessica and Clive Aspin. *Sexuality & the Stories of Indigenous People*. Huia. 2007. ISBN 9781869692773.

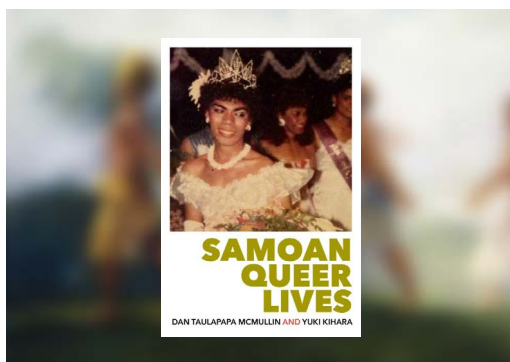
Sexuality and the Stories of Indigenous People is a brilliant collection of 17 essays by takatāpui of all different ages and walks of life. The authors explore aspects of being takatāpui through personal stories, poetry, and critical reflections. Among the authors are Kawe Mahara’s own chair, Dr Elizabeth Kerekere, and important historical figures like Georgina Beyer and Carmen Rupe.



Downfall: The Destruction of Charles Mackay

Diamond, Paul. *Downfall: The Destruction of Charles Mackay*. Massey University Press, 2022. ISBN 9781991016188.

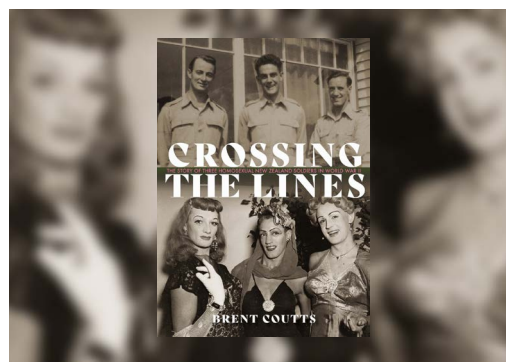
Downfall by Paul Diamond examines the life and eventual destruction of Whanganui’s gay mayor Charles Mackay, exploring his rise, controversies, and lasting impact on literature and journalism.



Samoan Queer Lives

Tualapapa McMullin, Dan and Yuki Kihara. *Samoan Queer Lives*. Little Island. 2018.

Samoan Queer Lives is a landmark collection of 14 personal stories from fa'afafine, transgender, and queer people of Samoa.



Crossing the Lines: The Story of Three Homosexual New Zealand Soldiers in WWII

Coutts, Brent. *Crossing the Lines: The Story of Three Homosexual New Zealand Soldiers in WWII*. Otago University Press. 2020. ISBN 9781988592381.

In *Crossing the Lines* Brent Coutts shines a light on the stories of homosexual soldiers during the Second World War, centering on the lives of drag artists Harold Robinson, Ralph Dyer and Douglas Morison.

Other non-fiction histories:

Te Awekōtuku, Ngāhuia, Shirley Tamihana, Julie Glamuzina and Alison Laurie. "Lesbian Organising." In Anne Else (ed.), *Women Together*. Daphne Brasell Associates Press. 1993.

Updated 2018 and published online: nzhistory.govt.nz/women-together/theme/lesbian

Cox, Lois. *That's What I Am: Oral Histories of Older Lesbians*. Town Belt Press. 2025.

Guy, Laurie. *Worlds in Collision: The Gay Debate in New Zealand 1960-1986*. Victoria University Press. 2002.

Alice, Lynne and Lynne Star. *Queer in Aotearoa New Zealand*. Dunmore Press. 2004.

Laurie, Alison. *Lesbian Studies in Aotearoa/New Zealand*. Harrington Park Press. 2001.

Gearing, Nigel. *Emerging Tribe: gay culture in New Zealand in the 1990s*. Penguin Books. 1997.

Brickell, Chris. *Manly Affections: The Photographs of Robert Gant, 1885-1915*. Genre Books. 2012.

Biographies



Change for the Better: The Story of Georgina Beyer as told to Cathy Casey

Beyer, Georgina and Cathy Casey. *Change for the Better: The Story of Georgina Beyer as Told to Cathy Casey*. Random House. 1999.

Change for the Better is a wonderful insight into the first half of the life of Georgina Beyer, most well known as the first out trans person in the world to become a Mayor and, later, a Member of Parliament. The biography explores her childhood, her coming out, sex worker days, acting career and early political career.



Hine Toa: A Story of Bravery

Te Awekōtuku, Ngāhua. *Hine Toa: A Story of Bravery*. Harper Collins. 2024.

Winner of the 2025 Ockham General Non-Fiction Award, *Hine Toa* is an extraordinary memoir by a trailblazing voice in women's, queer and Māori liberation movements.

Other biographies, memoirs, and diaries:

Rupe, Carmen and Paul Martin. ***Carmen: My Life, as told to Paul Martin***. Benton Ross. 1988.

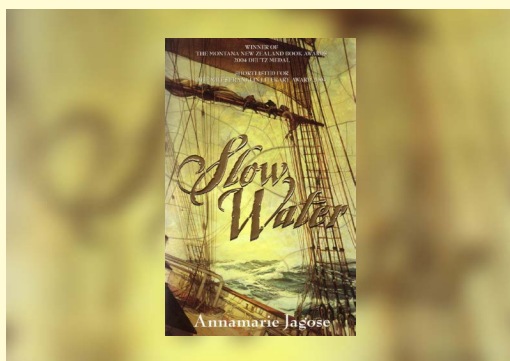
Renée. ***These Two Hands***. Mākaro Press. 2020.

Te Awekōtuku, Ngāhua. ***Mana Wāhine Māori: Selected Writings on Maori Women's Art, Culture and Politics***. New Women's Press. 1991.

Brickell, Chris, Vanessa Manhire and Nonnita Rees (eds.). ***Robert Lord Diaries***. Otago University Press. 2024.

Brickell, Chris. ***James Courage Diaries***. Otago University Press. 2021.

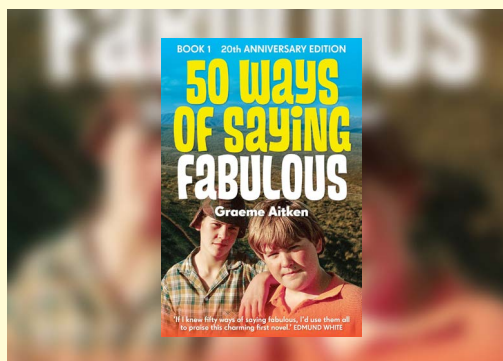
Historical fiction



Slow Water

Jagose, Annamarie. *Slow Water*. Victoria University Press. 2003.

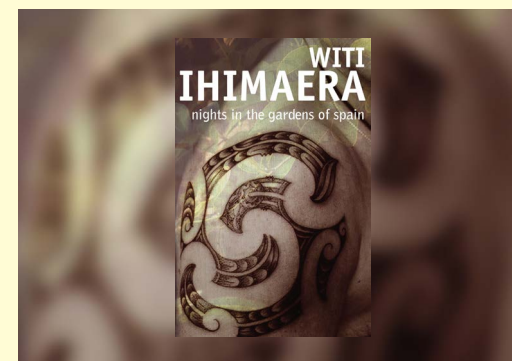
Slow Water is a based-on-a-true story novel about a famous gay scandal from Aotearoa's history. In 1836 English evangelist William Yate fell in love with third mate Edwin Denison during a four-month ship voyage to New Zealand. Yate was eventually turned upon by fellow voyagers, betrayed to church and civic authorities, and came within inches of hanging.



50 Ways of Saying Fabulous

Aitkin, Graeme. *50 Ways of Saying Fabulous*. Green Candy. 1995.

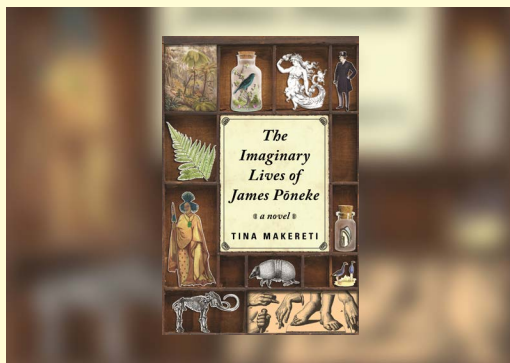
Graeme Aitkin's *50 Ways of Saying Fabulous* is a fun and heartfelt coming-of-age story about 12-year-old Billy, who grapples with sexuality and identity as a camp farmer's boy in rural Aotearoa during the 1990s.



Nights in the Gardens of Spain

Ihimaera, Witi. *Nights in the Gardens of Spain*. Penguin. 1996.

Famed author Witi Ihimaera's semi-autobiographical *Nights in the Gardens of Spain* is about a middle-aged man confronting his double life, and the impact that his coming out has on his family. It is a vibrant exploration of one man's gay life in the 1980s.



The Imaginary Lives of James Pōneke

Makareti, Tina. *The Imaginary Lives of James Pōneke*. Penguin. 2018.

Tina Makareti's *The Imaginary Lives of James Pōneke* is a novel set in the late 19th century and tells the story of James (Hemi), a young Māori boy who travels to London and encounters a whole new world of desires.

Other historical fiction:

Courage, James. *A Way of Love*. Cape. 1959.

Lloyd Jenkins, Douglas. *Shelter*. David Bateman. 2022.

Wells, Peter and Rex Pilgrim (eds.). *Best Mates: Gay Writing in Aotearoa New Zealand*. Reed. 1997.

Theses

Want something more in depth? Don't be daunted by these theses!

They are excellent, accessible reads that cover a whole range of historical and archival topics.

Kawe Mahara Queer Archives Aotearoa (formerly known as the Lesbian and Gay Archives of New Zealand Te Pūrangā)

Kerekere, Elizabeth. 'Part of The Whānau: The Emergence of Takatāpui Identity - He Whāriki Takatāpui'. Victoria University of Wellington. 2017. <https://doi.org/10.26686/wgtn.17060225>

Came, Heather. 'Aspects of bisexual politics'. University of Canterbury. 1992. <https://ir.canterbury.ac.nz/items/bbac9ac0-7887-4a9f-b39b-8f3dc1c58a6f>

Day, Alison. 'The collecting and connecting experiences of LGBTQ+ communities, LGBTQ+ independent archives and the GLAMU sector in Aotearoa New Zealand.' Victoria University of Wellington. 2025. <https://doi.org/10.26686/nhmx-madh>

Feu'u, Ashleigh. 'Ia e Ola Malamalama I Iou Fa'asinomaga: A comparative study of the fa'afafine of Samoa and the whakawahine of Aotearoa/New Zealand'. Victoria University of Wellington. 2013. <https://doi.org/10.26686/wgtn.17006278>

Hansen, Will. "'Every Bloody Right To Be Here': Trans Resistance in Aotearoa New Zealand, 1967-1989'. Victoria University of Wellington. 2020. <https://doi.org/10.26686/wgtn.17145932>

Hansen, Will. 'Queer Activism in Aotearoa New Zealand, 1961-2013'. Victoria University of Wellington. 2023. <https://doi.org/10.26686/wgtn.28766321>

Laurie, Alison. 'Lady-Husbands and Kamp Ladies: Pre-1970 Lesbian Life in Aotearoa/New Zealand'. Victoria University of Wellington. 2003. <https://doi.org/10.26686/wgtn.16947304>

Pearman, Louise. 'Men and Masqueraders: cross-gendered identity and behaviour in New Zealand, 1906-1950.' University of Otago. 2008. <https://ourarchive.otago.ac.nz/handle/10523/6794>

Ramsay, Erin. "'I Love Who I Am as a Nonbinary Person—That's When I'm Most at Home": Life-Stories of Nonbinary Adults and Elders from Aotearoa New Zealand Spanning 1953 to 2023.' Victoria University of Wellington. 2023. <https://doi.org/10.26686/wgtn.24121335>

Scordino, Jordan. 'Commitment, Creativity and Compassion': Responses to HIV/AIDS in New Zealand, 1983-1993'. University of Auckland. 2022. <https://researchspace.auckland.ac.nz/server/api/core/bitstreams/da976114-d146-4987-b082-a462da72abf1/content>

Wolfgramm, Penni. 'Leiti in Red: Exploring the Life Experiences of Kau Leiti Tonga Living in Aotearoa New Zealand'. University of Auckland. 2024. <https://elibrary.tnu.edu.to/cgi-bin/koha/opac-retrieve-file.pl?id=1d06485d5e2bc48cd7aab3922c46c25e>

Rainbow reads and reels

Rainbow reels

Thanks to the internet,
there are loads of places
online where you can
watch historic queer
content for free!

NZOnScreen

NZOnScreen has a wonderful collection of free-to-watch videos from Aotearoa's past, and has curated a queer collection.

nzonscreen.com/collection/the-lgbt-collection

Ngā Taonga Sound & Vision

Ngā Taonga Sound & Vision is Aotearoa's archive of audiovisual material, and they have a tonne of queer content! Some content is digitised, but most requires you to book an appointment or make an enquiry online.

ngataonga.org.nz

Will's YouTube Playlist

Trustee Will Hansen has been creating a YouTube playlist of historic queer videos found on the site. The playlist includes interviews, music videos, protest footage, panel discussions, short films, and even full documentaries!

youtube.com/playlist?list=PL9rZdnGe0yHhOJHAzV6MRzu1naDUPE6g2&si=kNtTvVTlbnN5zCIK

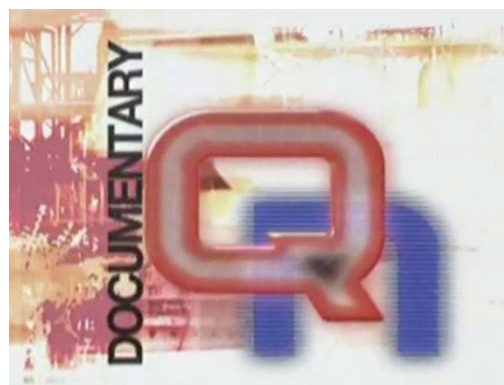
Our top picks



The Topp Twins: Do Not Adjust Your Twin-set

The Topp Twins have put all full episodes from the three seasons of their award-winning first tv show, The Topp Twins: Do Not Adjust Your Twin-set on YouTube! It showcased a beloved cast of Kiwi characters – including Camp Mother, the Bowling Ladies and the cross-dressing Ken and Ken. The twins took part in everything from triathlons to speedway races and the Pasifika festival.

youtu.be/JQZ2cltO19g?si=q9N19O7fguhiU0SW



Queer Nation

Queer Nation was a factual series by, for and about queer New Zealanders that ran from 1997 to 2004. NZOnScreen have digitised multiple full length episodes, covering everything from gay farmers in the Waikato to Katherine Mansfield's lesbian affairs, all presented in a deliciously Y2K way!

nzonscreen.com/title/queer-nation-1997/series



Jewel's Darl

A young Georgina Beyer stars in Peter Wells' gorgeous 1985 short film Jewel's Darl. The film is about the relationship between two trans women, Jewel (Georgina Beyer) and her newly-out girlfriend Mandy (Richard Hanna). A moving portrayal of trans love and defiance, it even features a scene of Georgina and Richard mockingly dancing next to a very real Salvation Army parade, at the height of the Salvation Army's anti-homosexual law reform campaign!

nzonscreen.com/title/about-face-jewels-darl-1985



Rainbow rangatira panel

In 2023 InsideOUT convened a Rainbow Rangatira Panel of four incredible elders - Ngāhuia Te Awekōtuku, Elizabeth Kerekere, Kevin Haunui and Mani Mitchell - to take a journey together down memory lane. Watch this panel to hear their stories, reflections and advice.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dYOCgSdjMc&list=PL9rZdnGe0yHhOJHAzV6MRzu1naDUPE6g2&index=42>



Carmen

Geoff Steven's 1989 documentary about Carmen Rupe, simply titled *Carmen*, is a brilliant portrayal of one of Aotearoa's most important - and most fabulous - transgender icons. The documentary traces her life from her birth in Taumarunui in 1936, through her times as a dancer, sex worker, cafe owner, activist, local celebrity – and one of the few non-MPs to appear before the Privileges Committee. The documentary also finds time for several ethereal fantasy sequences, featuring Georgina Buyer and Neil Gudsell (aka Mika).

nzonscreen.com/title/carmen-1989



An interview with Peter Alexander

In 1937 Palmerston North-born transgender man, Peter Alexander, was interviewed in Sydney about his life, alongside his partner. He talks about his childhood love of 'men's sports,' his views on women's place in society, and why he left New Zealand. That incredible interview has been archived by British Pathé and is available to watch on Youtube!

youtu.be/6XNLTbCy8Q?si=cPM38m4XCw-1wWpB

Queer archival collections

While Kawe Mahara is still in the process of digitising our collections, there are plenty of queer archives to look at online!

Pride NZ

PrideNZ.com is an incredible website run by local historians Gareth Watkins and Roger Smith, which hosts over 1,000 audio recordings of interviews and local events alongside an extensive rainbow timeline and free resource sets. Gareth and Roger also monthly run free walk tours of Wellington's queer history, which you can check out here: walktours.nz

The Charlotte Museum Te Whare Takatāpui-Wāhine o Aotearoa

The Charlotte Museum Te Whare Takatāpui-Wāhine o Aotearoa is a museum, research library and archive, gallery and space for Rainbow Community. It is home to over 1000 artifacts from Lesbian Sapphic herstory and broader Rainbow+ Communities in Aotearoa New Zealand, many of which are available to view online! Check out charlottemuseum.co.nz and their digital collections <https://ehive.com/collections/3024/the-charlotte-museum-te-whare-takatapui-wahine-o-aotearoa>

LGBTQI+ histories of Aotearoa New Zealand, Kōrero takatāpui ki Aotearoa

Te Papa's LGBTQIA+ Portal provides a home for Te Papa's beautiful and diverse queer collections - from the AIDS Quilt to Xena: Warrior Princess costumes - alongside stories from a range of queer New Zealanders.

tepapa.govt.nz/discover-collections/read-watch-play/lgbtqi-histories-aotearoa-new-zealand

Trans Past, Trans Present: The Making Trans Histories Project

Trans Past, Trans Present: The Making Trans Histories Project is a digital Te Papa collection of 29 objects and stories of personal importance to local trans people: tepapa.nz/makingtranshistories

The Rainbow List Project

The Rainbow List Project by Heritage New Zealand Te Pouhere Taonga aims to improve the diversity of the New Zealand Heritage List/Rārangi Kōrero (the List) by recognising places of significance to Aotearoa New Zealand's LGBTQI+ (lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender, takatāpui, fa'afāfine, queer and intersex) communities.

Browse the Rainbow List here: heritage.org.nz/places/rainbow-list-project

Queer History Research Guide

If you're doing research on queer histories, check out the National Library's Queer History Research Guide, compiled by Kawe Mahara trustee Will Hansen in 2017 to help researchers new to exploring local queer pasts: natlib.govt.nz/blog/tagged/598/queer-history

Smaller collections

Queer life is everywhere — and so too, are queer archives!

Archivists across the motu are working hard to surface queer archives within bigger collections.

We've listed some of the few that we're aware of — reach out if you know more.

Upper Hutt Rainbow Collection:

uhcl.recollect.co.nz/nodes/view/35425

Rainbow History of Victoria University Wellington:

tapuaka.wgtn.ac.nz/nodes/view/8130

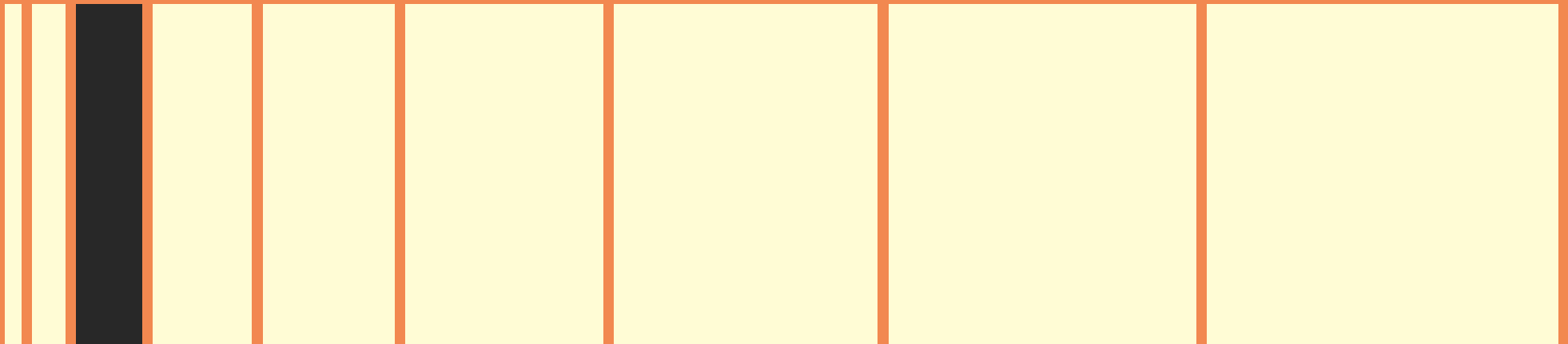
Wellington City Recollect's queer collections include:

- The Queen's Dragoons by Bryan Staff, a photo exhibit of local trans women:
wellington.recollect.co.nz/nodes/view/4212
- City Voice magazine published a regular 'Queer City' column in the 1990s:
wellington.recollect.co.nz/nodes/search?datefrom=&dateto=&keywords=%22queer+city%22&order=desc&orderby=relevance&ntids=W10%3D&page=1&viewtype=grid&type=all&in=0&inmetas=&digital=0

Auckland Libraries queer collections include some excellent oral histories:

- Queer Stories Our Fathers Never Told Us oral history project:
kura.aucklandlibraries.govt.nz/digital/collection/oralhistory/id/1174/
- RainbowYOUTH oral history project:
kura.aucklandlibraries.govt.nz/digital/collection/oralhistory/search/searchterm/RainbowYOUTH%20Collection/field/titlea/mode/exact/conn/and
- Kei Roto i te Miru, Inside the Bubble oral history project features four queer stories:
kura.aucklandlibraries.govt.nz/digital/collection/oralhistory/search/searchterm/Kei%20Roto%20I%20Te%20Miru%20-%20Inside%20the%20Bubble/field/titlea/mode/exact/conn/and
- Allyssa Verner-Pula, Pacific and queer: a talanoa, 2024:
kura.aucklandlibraries.govt.nz/digital/collection/oralhistory/id/4508/rec/18

Aotearoa queer history timeline



Aotearoa Queer History Timeline

There are many different Queer History timelines.

Timelines might focus on a particular aspect of Queer History, be concise or expansive.

PrideNZ offers several curated timelines and even a mega timeline based on notes by Gareth Watkins.

Here is a sample Queer History timeline with a few key dates and figures.

Te Ao Māori

Pre-colonisation

Māori societies recognised diverse gender and sexual identities, including takatāpui.

1300s

Tūtanekei proclaimed his love for Tiki.

1300s

Wairaka, daughter of the captain of the Mataatua waka recited a powerful karakia that included the phrase – “Ka whakatāne ake ahau i a au’ – I will make myself like a man.” – to help her paddle the waka to safety, saving her people.

Whakatāne is named after Wairaka’s words.

Colonisation and criminalisation

1840	1840	1890	1893	1907	1910	1917	1920
British law imposed in Aotearoa; male same-sex relations criminalised ("buggery" a capital offence).	Wiremu Maihi Te Rangikāheke wrote the story of the love triangle between Hinemoa, Tūtanekai and Tiki, using the words "taku hoa takatāpui" to describe Tūtanekai and Tiki's relationship.	Robert Gant is actively photographing his lovers and friends, often posing them in theatrical scenes.	Criminal Code Act is passed, and all sexual activity between men criminalised.	Katherine Mansfield writes her in journal about her lover Maata Mahupuku: "I want Maata - I want her as I have had her - terribly. This is unclean I know but true. What an extraordinary thing..." After Mansfield's death in 1923 it emerged that she had begun a novel entitled Maata.	Mountaineer Freda Du Faur becomes the first woman to ascend Aoraki Mt Cook. Her partner was Muriel Cadogan, and Freda named peaks in the Southern Alps for both Cadogan and herself.	Dr Hjelmar von Danneville is imprisoned for "suspicious activity" on Matiu/Somes Island. New Plymouth prison is used for the segregation of sex offenders, including homosexuals.	Mayor of Whanganui, Charles Mackay, is arrested for attempting to kill poet D'Archy Cresswell, who had tried to use Mackay's homosexuality to blackmail him out of public office.

Aotearoa Queer History Timeline

1940s

1945

Two women appear in court charged with offences under the Marriage Act, for living together as husband and wife for over a decade.

1946

Dunedin-born surgeon Harold Gillies carries out on the world's first gender affirmation surgeries.

1950s

1954

Teenagers Pauline Parker and Juliet Hulme are found guilty of murdering Parker's mother, and the trial highlighted the girls' fantasies and absorption with each other.

1959

Canterbury-born James Courage releases his novel *A Way of Love*, the first gay novel by a New Zealander.

1960s

1962

The Dorian Society, the oldest documented homosexual organisation in New Zealand, is formed in Wellington. In 1963 they formed a legal subcommittee to work towards law reform.

1964

Charles Aberhart is killed in Hagley Park by a group of six boys who wanted to "beat a queer."

1966

Carmen Rupe is arrested in Auckland for "behaving in an offensive manner in a public place" for the simple matter of wearing women's clothing.

The charge was dismissed by Judge McCarthy, who was unable to find any legal precedent that cross-dressing was illegal.

1967

New Zealand Homosexual Law Reform Society is established, catapulting the issue of decriminalisation into the public consciousness.

Carmen Rupe opens her first business in Wellington, Carmen's International Coffee Lounge.

1970s

1972

Activist Ngāhuia Te Awekōtuku is denied U.S. visa for being openly a lesbian. Fed up with discrimination, she calls on her comrades to create Aotearoa's first Gay Liberation Front.

Auckland Gay Liberation's first protest, "Gay Day," is held in Auckland's Albert Park.

Hedesthia, the first transgender organisation on record in Aotearoa, is formed in Lower Hutt.

1973

The first lesbian-feminist activist group in Aotearoa, SHE (Sisters for Homophile Equality) is formed in Christchurch, with a second chapter following not long after in Wellington.

1974

The first trans liberationist group in Aotearoa is formed, as a subgroup of the Christchurch Gay Liberation Front: the Transsexuals & Transvestites Union.

National MP Venn Young introduces the Crimes Amendment Bill, the first parliamentary attempt at homosexual law reform in NZ.

1975

Robin Duff stands as the first openly gay parliamentary candidate in New Zealand.

1976

Lesbian Summer Camp takes place in Canterbury.

1977

The first Vinegar Hill camp took place over New Years in the Manawatu. Beginning with only six campers, the event grew into an annual queer camping experience open to everyone.

The National Gay Rights Coalition is formed.

Carmen Rupe runs for Mayor of Wellington.

The Manawatu Gay Rights Association is formed in Palmerston North - and it is now Aotearoa's longest running queer organisation.

1980s

1980

Police raid Westside sauna in Auckland, arresting several men and immediately sparking a gay protest movement in response.

1984

The first person in New Zealand to die from AIDS-related complications.
Chrissy Witoko opens the Evergreen Coffee Lounge in Wellington, providing a friendly social environment for local queer people and other marginalised communities.

1985

Labour MP Fran Wilde introduces the Homosexual Law Reform Bill to Parliament, to decriminalise consensual sexual activity between males over the age of 16 and make it illegal to discriminate on the grounds of sexual orientation.
New Zealand AIDS Foundation established; major petition for law reform gains ~50,000 signatures.

1986

Homosexual Law Reform Act passes (9 July).
Just two months after the passing of the Homosexual Law Reform Act the Lesbian and Gay Rights Resource Centre (now Kawe Mahara) is torched and trashed by arsonists.
First national safe-sex campaign launched by NZAF.

1987-1988

First AIDS conference (1987) and open HIV testing begins (1988).

1990s

1991

First AIDS Memorial Quilt unfolding ceremony in Aotearoa.

1992

The HERO Festival begins in Auckland, and is held annually until 2001.

1993

Human Rights Act passed – prohibits discrimination based on sexual orientation.

Chris Carter becomes NZ's first openly gay MP.

1995

Georgina Beyer is elected Mayor of Carterton - becoming the first openly trans mayor in the world.

1996

Antiretroviral therapy (ART) becomes accessible in NZ.

Weekly tv show Express Report begins, and is soon developed into a regular series titled Queer Nation. It featured rainbow news, events and profiles from around the country.

Spectrum, one of NZ's earliest queer websites, is launched by a social and support group of the same name in Nelson.

Action for Marriage campaign.

1997

Mani Mitchell creates the Intersex Society of New Zealand.

1999

Georgina Beyer elected MP – the world's first openly transgender Member of Parliament.

2000s

2001

Tiwhanawhana, a takatāpui community group, is founded in Wellington.

2003

Prostitution Reform Act passes - fought for by NZPC.

Yellow for Hermaphrodites - Mani's Story comes out on TVNZ.

2004

Civil unions introduced – relationship recognition regardless of gender.

Destiny Church's "Enough is Enough" rally and queer counter-protest, featuring a staunch Georgina Beyer.

2005

Agender NZ rally in front of Parliament in support of the Human Rights (Gender Identity) Bill.

2006

Crown Law Office confirm that discrimination against trans people would fall under the category of 'sex' discrimination.

2008

To Be Who I Am, Human Rights Commission report on trans communities is released.

2010s

2011

First NZ 'Pink Shirt Day' run by several queer youth groups throughout the country.

First Queer the Night March in Wellington - catalyses the formation of the Queer Avengers.

LegaliseLove founded.

2012

Marriage (Definition of Marriage) Amendment Bill introduced, and Campaign for Marriage Equality formed.

PrEP becomes available in NZ.

2013

Marriage Equality – same-sex marriage becomes legal (19 August).

2014

Gender Minorities Aotearoa formed.

2015

A trio of radical queers protest the inclusion of police & corrections in Auckland Pride Parade, and subsequently form No Pride in Prisons (later People Against Prisons Aotearoa).

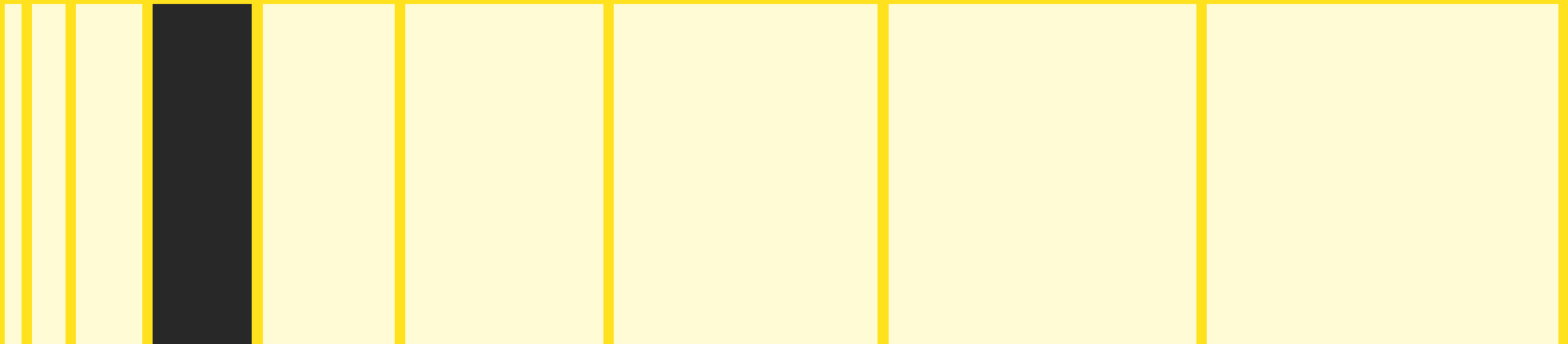
2019

Auckland Pride Festival leads #OurMarch, a grassroots, community-driven response to the withdrawals of police and businesses from the parade following Pride's decision to ask police not to march in uniform in 2018.

2020s – Today

2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2026
InsideOut leads Aotearoa's first National Schools' Pride Week.	Queer Endurance in Defiance founded, and host their first protest against an anti-transgender seminar. The Births, Deaths, Marriages and Relationships Registration Act passes, allowing self-identification of a person's sex on their birth certificates. Nevertheless is founded, initially as a clothing brand but transforming into a Māori, Pasifika and Takatāpui Rainbow+ mental health non-profit organisation. Adhikaar Aotearoa, an educational and support service for queer people of colour becomes a registered charity.	Conversion therapy banned – Conversion Practices Prohibition Legislation Act.	Trans Liberation Alliance lead a massive protest in Auckland, in response to British anti-trans campaigner Posie Parker's speaking tour. Mana Tipua is established in 2023 following a Takatāpui Taiohi Ora Hui run at Rehua Marae in by InsideOUT Koaro, where a need was identified for a Te Waipounamu (South Island) based kaupapa Māori service to support takatāpui youth.	The Lesbian and Gay Archives of New Zealand, Te Pūranga Takatāpui o Aotearoa, changes name to Kawe Mahara Queer Archives Aotearoa.	40th anniversary of the Homosexual Law Reform Act.

Homosexual law reform



Homosexual law reform



Here are some resources on Homosexual Law Reform from Kawe Mahara:

Key Events surrounding Homosexual Law Reform in New Zealand

This information is based on Phil Parkinson's Key Events article.

laganz.org.nz/audio/keyEvents.html

Audio from the Homosexual Law Reform Debate

laganz.org.nz/audio/index.html

Homosexual Law Reform Retrospective

This section reproduces a number of articles, including personal accounts, which appeared in issues of the Friends of LAGANZ newsletter in 1995 and 1996. Issue No. 10 (June 1996) was the 10th Anniversary of Law Reform Commemorative Issue.

laganz.org.nz/resources/lawreform.html

Programme from 20 Years On – Homosexual Law Reform Conference

laganz.org.nz/conference/2006ConfProgrFinal30Nov06.pdf

From Pride NZ

Journey to Homosexual Law Reform

pridenz.com/time/homosexual_law_reform.html

40 years of love

Celebrating the past, while looking to the future.

40yearsoflove.nz

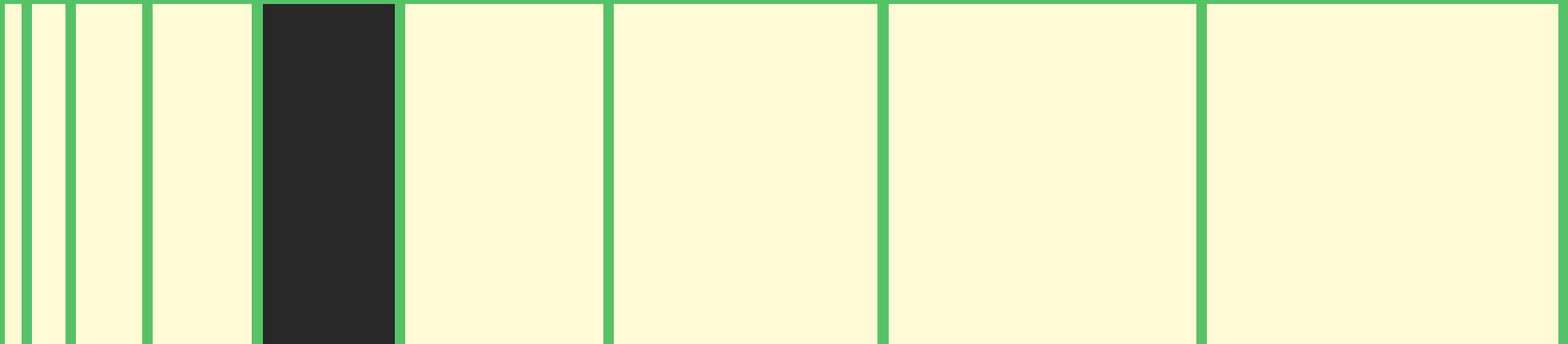
Stay tuned for an upcoming verbatim play on Homosexual Law Reform by Lori Leigh.

Top left: MP Gerald Wall addresses Homosexual Law Reform Supporters, Wellington, 1977. Ref: *EP-Ethics-Demonstrations-Homosexual Law Reform-02*.

Right: Wellington street march in support of the Homosexual Law Reform bill, Wellington, 1986. *David Hindley Collection, Kawe Mahara*.

Bottom left: Labour MPs Ruth Dyson, Fran Wilde and Trevor Mallard celebrate the Homosexual Law Reform Act passing its final reading, Wellington, 1986. *David Hindley Collection, Kawe Mahara*.

Queer Archives: Preserving activist and personal histories



WE ARE PROUD OF OUR PERVERSION

10%+ OF NEW ZEALANDERS ARE GAY

WE VOTE TOO WATCH OUT MARGINAL SEATS

END PASSEX REPRESSION OF PEOPLE

IDEATH HUVICTORIAN SEXITUDEN

KIRK-NZ's DI AMYNN RANK' SLEEPS HERE

IN SOCIETIES WHERE WOMEN ARE OPPRESSED TO BE LESBIAN IS A SIGN OF MENTAL HEALTH

YOU USE TAXES WE PAY TO DISCRIMINATE AGAINST US!

Hi Mum

Queer archives have been central to the collecting of protest and personal histories.

Many of these, like the Lesbian Herstory Archives in NYC and ArQuives in Toronto, were established in the 1970s and early 1980s to document the protests of the Gay Liberation movement.

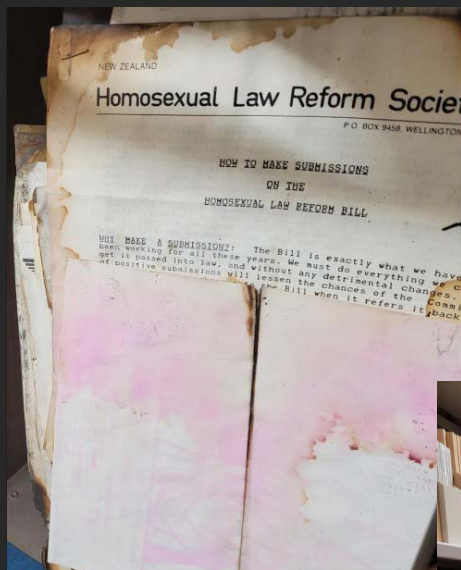
In Aotearoa New Zealand, records of the activities of people and organisations involved in the Gay Liberation movement were collected by LAGANZ, the Lesbian and Gay Archives of New Zealand, which started out as the Lesbian and Gay Rights Resource Centre in 1977.

After the passage of the Homosexual Law Reform Act, documenting protests and campaigns continued, the Civil Unions Act 2004, the Marriage Equality Act 2023 and the prohibition of conversion therapy in 2022, amongst many.

Personal collections make up a considerable part of the collections, as well as documentation of events, not just rallies and protests, but also balls, social functions, and everyday queer life.

As gender and sexual identity become more fluid, queer archives, like Kawe Mahara, seek to collect records that represent their diverse queer communities. All queer communities are involved in protests, and since the turn of the millennium, two other queer repositories have emerged in this evolving identity space: the Charlotte Museum (2006) and PrideNZ (2009). Between the three organisations, they collect the majority of formats, with PrideNZ recording audios of events and interviews. The Charlotte Museum collects objects, books, and other formats. Kawe Mahara is currently a physical archive (with moves towards digitisation and digital collections) that collects documents, audio and video recordings, various ephemera, and objects.

Queer Archives: Preserving activist and personal histories



Above: Charred submissions from the 1986 fire in the Kawe Mahara archives at the Alexander Turnbull Library. Photo by Alison Day.



Right: Kawe Mahara archives at the Alexander Turnbull Library. Photo by Alison Day.

The latter are subject to the Alexander Turnbull Library (ATL) policy, under the agreement, which precludes the collecting of artefacts better suited to a museum.

This leads to sustainability, which is a major concern for all three organisations. Since its inception in the 1970s, Kawe Mahara has been operated by volunteers and supported by grants and monetary donations. This is common across the community archiving system and often results in a precarious situation. The earliest and largest queer archive, ONE Archives, established back in the early 1950s, had by 2010 donated all its collections to the University of Southern California, as it became unsustainable for the community to keep operating.

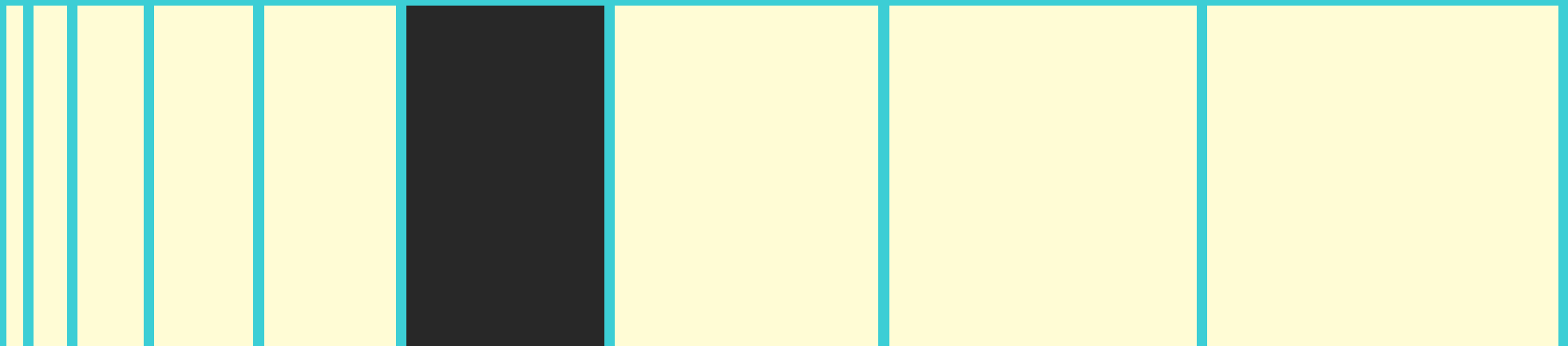
Occasionally, grants are available. The Charlotte Museum has been digitising its collections through successful grant applications. Please explore their online collection or visit them in Auckland to see their amazing exhibitions.

PrideNZ was approached by the National Library about preserving its collection after it was accepted into the Library of Congress in 2021. This has resulted in a donation of PrideNZ's master files to the Alexander Turnbull Library (which retains them in perpetuity) and an ongoing donation of about 4-5 files per month.

You can access PrideNZ collections through the ATL website and on PrideNZ. All audio files are under a Creative Commons Licence.

The history of queer activism and queer lives cannot exist without archives and museums willing to preserve our stories, and there is no record of queer existence if undocumented. Retaining personal documents has been fraught with risk. Queer histories and stories were often destroyed as they were too incriminating, putting people at risk with employers, with the law, or families who did not want the exposure. Knowing you are welcome and safe in an archive and that your privacy will be respected is a major concern, and our queer community archives and museums understand and act accordingly. Donating a collection to queer community archives and museums, such as Kawe Mahara and the Charlotte Museum, recognises its queer value, helps ensure its preservation, and reinforces the importance of these organisations in society. Having our own archives and museum means our queer communities can see themselves represented and trust that their stories are cared for and preserved for the queer generations to come.

KAMP adventures: What can you do for Queer History Month Aotearoa?



What can we do for Queer History Month Aotearoa?

Below is a list of possible activities to acknowledge Queer History Month Aotearoa.

These activities can be adapted for use in a variety of settings from community organisations to classrooms.

You may find the other resources in this pack useful as you create and plan your activities. Partnering with other groups to enhance the reach and impact of your events may also be useful.

Host a Queer History panel or guest speaker lecture

Approach people in your area who are prepared to take part in an evening of talks and questions. If you need any suggestions in your area, contact us.

Organise a Book Club

There are some great books to get you started in the Rainbow Reads & Reels section (see page 6).

Organise a Queer History quiz

One of our Board Trustees, Will Hansen, has created a Queer History Quiz, complete with answers.

Perfect for pubs, student societies and networking groups. If you would like a copy, please email us.

Book a historical walking tour

[Walk Tours NZ](#) hosts free community Rainbow-themed Walk Tours in Wellington.

Don't have something in your area? Creating a local Rainbow-themed walk tour in your area would be an incredible way to celebrate Queer History.



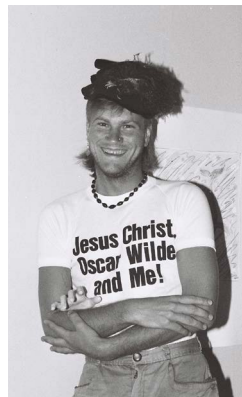
Host an evening of readings from memoirs, biographies, poems and fiction

Aotearoa has many amazing Queer writers- Katherine Mansfield, Frank Sargeson, Witi Ihimaera, James Courage, Robert Lord.

For Takatāpui literature, see for example Elizabeth Kerekere et al.'s work *Preparing the art world for Māori dykes*.

Put up a display or create a visual timeline

InsideOUT has downloadable [Rainbow Rangitara posters](#) which you can print and display for Queer History Month.



What can we do for Queer History Month Aotearoa?

Have a fancy dress party

Dress up as a historical Queer person.



Volunteer for Queer Archives

Kawe Mahara has a range of activities suitable for volunteers, many of which involve working from home, online as well as working with collections directly.

Arrange a fundraiser night for Queer Archives in Aotearoa (Kawe Mahara or the Charlotte Museum)

Organise a Queer History arts and crafts event

You might make a theme such as “protest posters” or badge-making and use archival material for inspiration.

Collages are a very queer medium - print off copies of queer archives or hunt in op shops for fun second-hand material, and get creating!

Your own activity

These are just a few ideas. Use your imagination!

Show a film (or series of films)

Again, you might find some inspiration in our Rainbow Reads & Reels section.



Are you planning an event for Queer History Month Aotearoa?

Tell us about it by filling out our form:

cognitoforms.com/kawemaharaqueerarchivesaotearoa/qhm

Use the hashtag #QueerHistoryMonthAotearoa and tag Kawe Mahara in any of your marketing and we will share to help spread the word.

If you would like support with any event you are running, please get in touch with us.

*Photographs on this page and previous:
David Hindley Collection, Kawe Mahara.*

What can we do for Queer History Month Aotearoa?

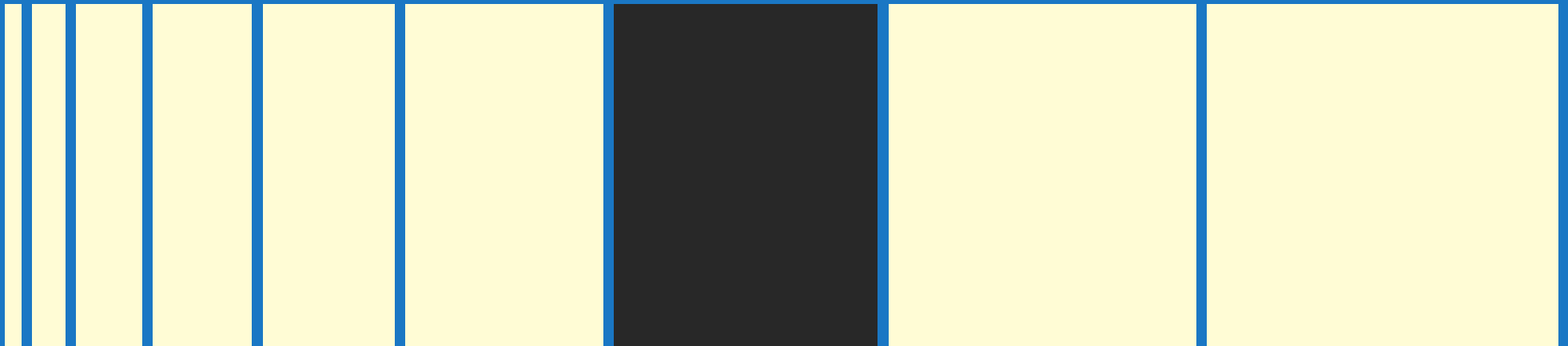


Will Hansen and Lori Leigh as Hudson and Halls hosting
“Rainbow Rewind: Queer History Month Quiz
by Kawe Mahara” 2025

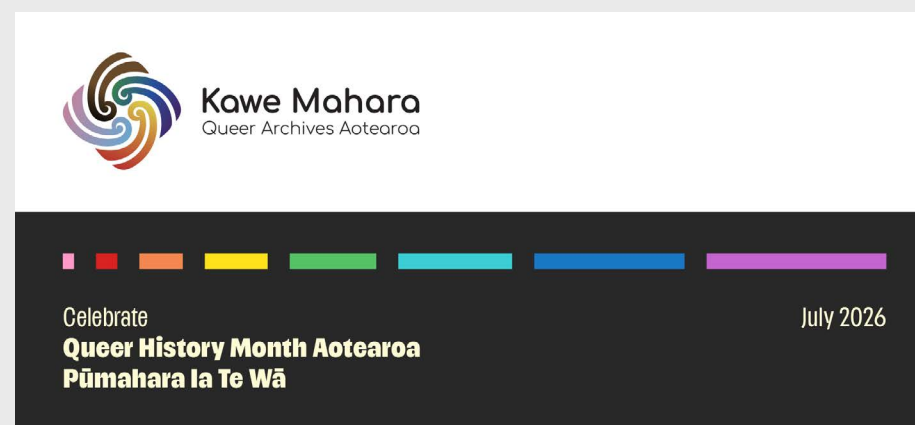
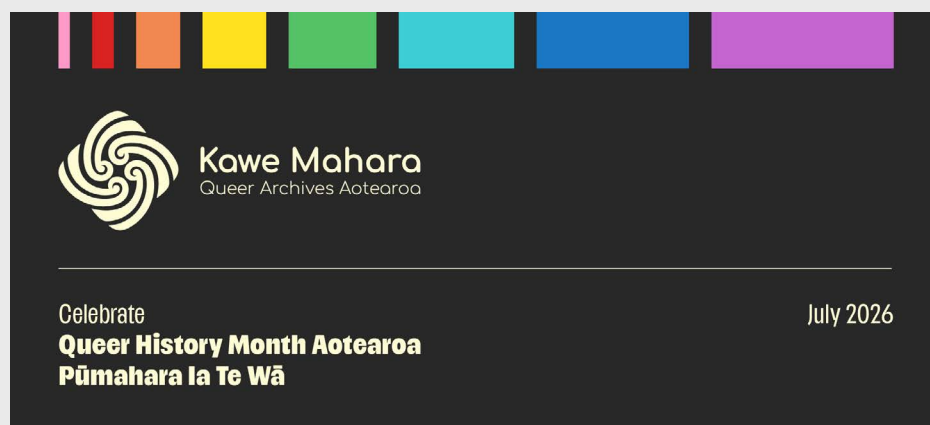


Leilani Sio, Kerry Pollock, Gareth Watkins at the Newtown
Library’s “Queer Histories of Pōneke” talk in 2024.

Email signatures, logos, banners

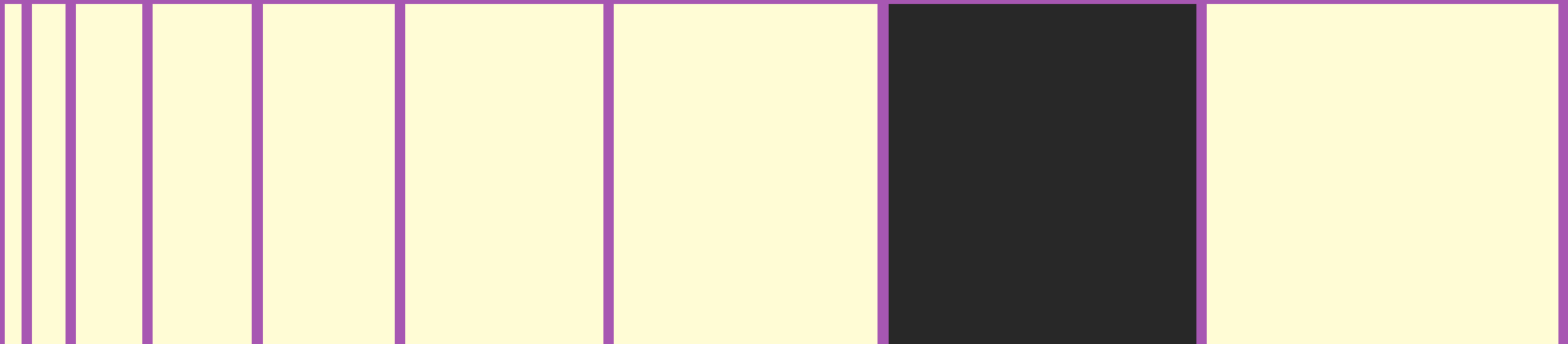


Email signatures, logos, banners



Download and use these banners for free from our website: laganz.org.nz

Meet the memory keepers



Meet the Memory Keepers

Learn a bit about the Kawe Mahara Trustees



Dr Elizabeth Kerekere (Chair - she/her)

Prof Elizabeth Kerekere (she/her/ia) (Whānau a Kai, Ngāti Oneone, Te Āitanga a Māhaki, Rongowhakaata, Ngāi Tāmanuhiri, Co. Clare, Co. Tipperary) is the chair of Kawe Mahara Queer Archives Aotearoa. Elizabeth is a LGBTQIA+ activist and scholar of national and international renown.

She has been active within Rainbow and youth development sectors for over 35 years and mentored over 60 youth leaders. She is founder/chair of Tiwhanawhana Trust which advocates for takatāpui to “tell our stories, build our communities and leave a legacy”. Elizabeth’s PhD on takatāpui identity and well-being is required reading in universities here and overseas.

Her takatāpui suicide prevention resources are used in health and school settings across the country and Elizabeth has brought Te Tiriti o Waitangi/takatāpui-based advice to research projects addressing assisted reproductive health and family formation, LGBTQIA+ youth health and well-being, trans and non-binary health and well-being, and intersex human rights.

As a Member of Parliament in the last term, Elizabeth broke records with the petition that led to banning conversion practices, contributed to new gender markers on birth certificates for trans, intersex and non-binary people and she introduced the term ‘takatāpui’ into legislation for the first time in the reform of the health system.

Elizabeth’s framework for takatāpui health and well-being Te Whare Takatāpui is currently being applied to the health system and she was appointed Adjunct Professor in Public Health at Victoria University of Wellington this year.

Meet the Memory Keepers | Learn a bit about the Kawe Mahara Trustees



Roger Swanson (he/him)

Roger has worked as a librarian at the Parliamentary Library, the National Library of New Zealand and finally at the Alexander Turnbull Library. He retired in 2019. He began volunteering with the Archive in the early 1980's and joined the Board in the 1990's. He has also served as Acting Curator and is currently a member of the Curatorial Team with Linda. Until recently Roger was Secretary for Kawe Mahara.

Roger was a founder and co-ordinator of Ascent Wellington - a group for Lesbian and Gay Catholics.

Roger's main focus is ensuring that research enquiries are responded to and that newly donated items are arranged, described and made ready for use by researchers. Roger organises working bees for volunteers to assist with this work.



Linda Evans (she/her)

Linda has been a voluntary curator of the collections of Kawe Mahara Queer Archives Aotearoa (formerly LAGANZ) since the 1990s. She recently joined the Board as a trustee, continuing her focus on curatorial work with the collections.

Linda has been involved in many lesbian groups in Pōneke since the 1970s, including co-producing and presenting the Lesbian Radio Programme on Wellington Access Radio from 1984-1997. She was also active in the campaign for homosexual law reform and anti-discrimination legislation from the late 1970s.

She worked in libraries and archives from 1977-1995, including over 30 years as curator of oral history at the Alexander Turnbull Library.

Her personal research focus has been on lesbian communities and histories, and she is committed to encouraging and assisting all Wellington's queer communities to preserve and make use of their many and varied histories.

Meet the Memory Keepers

Learn a bit about the Kawe Mahara Trustees



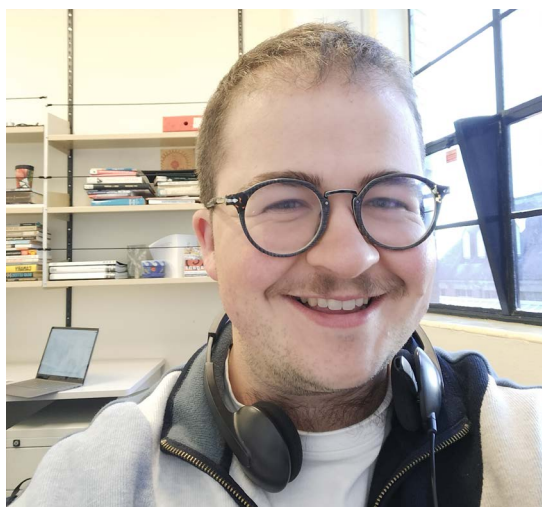
Gavin Hamilton (he/him)

Gavin joined the Board of Kawe Mahara, formerly LAGANZ, back in 1999 and is the Board's Treasurer.

Gavin has a Masters of Library and Information Studies (MLIS) from Te Herenga Waka–Victoria University of Wellington and has worked as a public servant in the IT, publishing and websites management fields since the 1990s. Gavin also volunteered for 15 years with Reel Queer, the organisers of the Out Takes film festivals.

Developing Kawe Mahara's metadata framework for describing collections and collection items, completing the digitisation of the catalogue index cards and setting up processes to collect digital and digitised materials are Gavin's current focus. Gavin is also stewarding work towards our longer term goals of commissioning a digital collecting, access and preservation platform and creating "linked data". Linked data would mean collaborating and exchanging metadata describing Kawe Mahara's collection items with other regional and local archives, museums and libraries so that researchers can be exposed to those items held in other institutions when they use our online catalogue.

Gavin enjoys helping to create opportunities for all the diverse queer communities of Aotearoa New Zealand to preserve and connect with their local history.



Will Hansen (he/him)

Will is a Pākehā trans man and historian based in Pōneke who became a trustee of Kawe Mahara in 2017. He joined after completing an internship with the National Library to create a Queer History Research Guide, being mentored by Kawe Mahara curator and trustee Roger Swanson.

Queer history - preserving and sharing it - is Will's greatest passion! His Masters thesis explored histories of trans resistance in Aotearoa, and his doctorate dove into queer activist histories from 1961 to 2013. Kawe Mahara's collections have been essential to Will's research, and he enjoys being both a user and guardian of the archives.

Will's focus on the board has largely been around public engagement, figuring out ways of bringing the archives to the communities it represents, and vice versa. His favourite project so far has been the Archive is Alive zine series, a collaborative effort with Wellington Zinefest which occurred annually from 2020 to 2022. Each iteration of the project involved an intensive two-day workshop, where participants spent one day immersed in archives and history, and another working together to create a zine about what they learnt, before celebrating later at a launch party.

Will loves having the opportunity to connect with local archives and histories on such an intimate level, and sharing this profound joy with others.

Meet the Memory Keepers

Learn a bit about the Kawe Mahara Trustees



Dr Lori Leigh (they/her)

Dr Lori Leigh joined the Board of Kawe Mahara in 2024 shortly after attending the inaugural Queer History Month Aotearoa – Pūmahara Ia Te Wā 2024 hui taumata.

Dr. Lori Leigh is an award-winning interdisciplinary researcher, artist, creative writer, and educator whose work bridges queer studies, arts and culture, public health and urban studies. Lori's special expertise is in queer history and heritage, cultural memory and community-centred creative practice. They continue to develop their interests in lesbian and trans histories, queer artists/activists, and queer spaces and landmarks.

Lori was recently awarded both an Oral History Grant from the Ministry for Culture & Heritage and CLNZ | NZSA Research Grant for work on their project "Homo Sweet Homo": The History of New Zealand's Queer Homes, which aims to explore the vibrant and diverse landscape of queerness and home-making in Aotearoa New Zealand.

Lori values queer history for its power to expand how we think about gender, sexuality, family, and place, while grounding these understandings in connection to queer tīpuna and whakapapa.



Dr Alison Day (she/they)

Alison loves archives and history, and not necessarily in that order. Alison's recently completed PhD at Victoria University of Wellington looked at how Aotearoa New Zealand's queer communities collect, document, and donate their stories, and how our queer archives and museums support this mahi. Making queer material easier to find and access has become a big focus, and queer metadata and description has turned into a genuine passion.

As part of the 2023 Queer Metadata Collective research group, Alison helped create Best Practices for Queer Metadata. After joining the Board in 2024, Alison has been excited to start building connections with our communities and encouraging more collecting and donating to preserve our memories and keep our stories alive.

Meet the Memory Keepers

Learn a bit about the Kawe Mahara Trustees



T Peters (they/them)

T (Theresa) Peters is a non-binary, documentary photographer / videographer and longtime activist.

T spent their 20's and 30's traveling the globe, building community and documenting the diversity of queer gatherings and communities they spent time in, along with the diversity of cultures they travelled amongst. T feels that documenting, sharing and archiving our stories, struggles and strengths helps preserve our collective culture, offering a bedrock for future generations of our rainbow whānau, to awhi them into the future with strength, knowledge and sense of belonging.

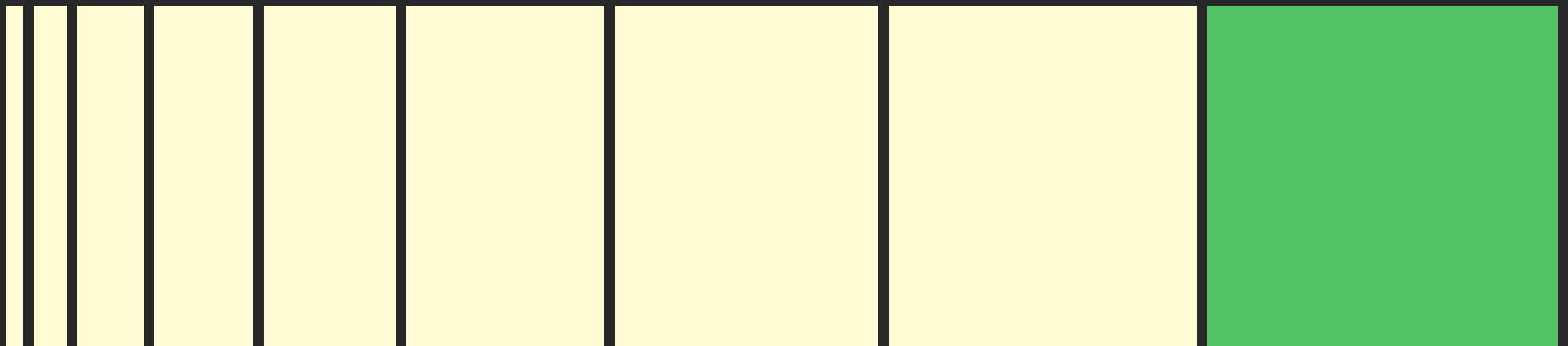
T has called Aotearoa home since 1998 and their current mahi, as a Diversity, Equity and Inclusion Lead, is an extension of their activism to help create community, government and corporate environments where all people, including our rainbow whānau, are safe, belong and can thrive.

T became a trustee of Kawe Mahara in 2024 as a way of taking an active role in being a Kaitiaki of our shared Queer history.

T lives in Tāmaki Makaurau, and is currently the only trustee that lives outside of Pōneke, T would like to help make the archives more accessible across the motu.

T understands that knowledge is power and the best way to keep our communities safe and thriving is to preserve and control the narrative of our own stories.

Queer History Month calendar



Queer History Month calendar

Kawe Mahara encourages everyone to get involved in Queer History Month!

To make it easy for participants to know about all the gorgeous events being planned by people around the country, Kawe Mahara coordinates an annual Queer History Month Calendar, shared on social media.

To add your event to the calendar, message us on social media or send us an email with the details. Your event doesn't need to be big or flashy for it to be added! #QueerHistoryMonthAotearoa

You can also tell us about it by filling out our form:

cognitoforms.com/kawemaharaqueerarchivesaotearoa/qhm

Thank you. Ngā mihi.



Kawe Mahara
Queer Archives Aotearoa